

Coding Discussion: Recursive Thinking

Design and Analysis of Algorithms

Brian C. Dean

**School of Computing
Clemson University**



I Thought About Writing Some Code in Scheme...

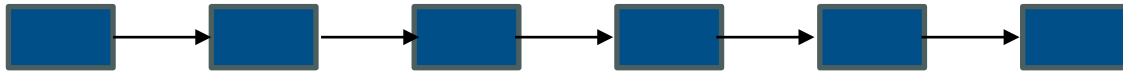
... but then I reconsidered.

$$N! = N \times \underbrace{(N-1) \times (N-2) \times (N-3) \times \dots \times 2 \times 1}_{(N-1)!}$$

```
(define (fact N) (if (= N 0) 1 (* N (fact (- N 1)))))
```

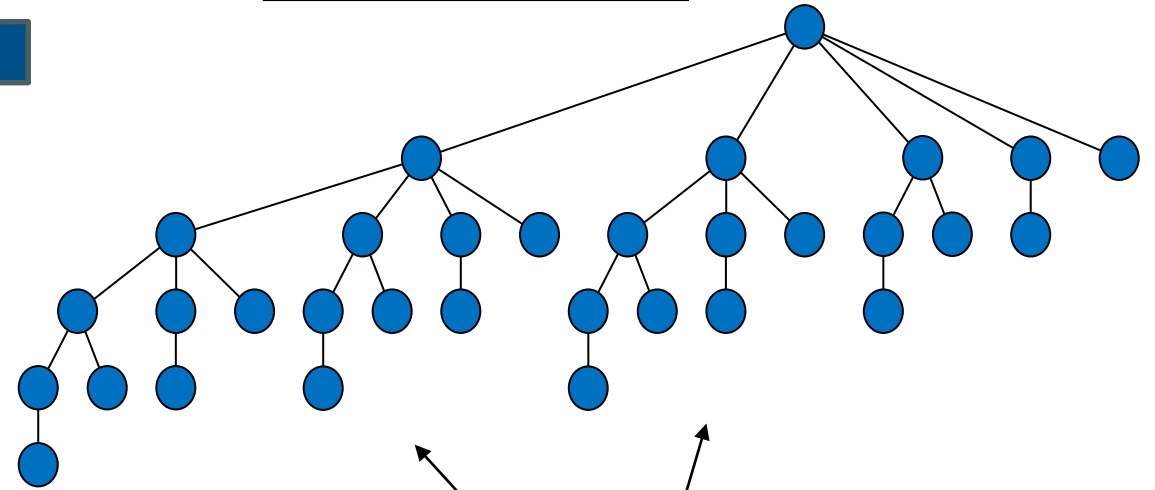
Recursive Structure in Common Data Structures

Linked list:



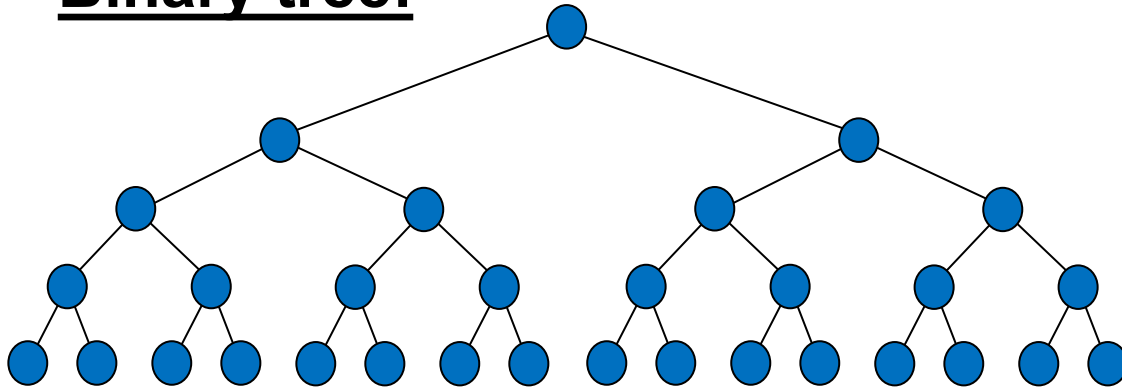
Also a linked list!

Binomial tree:



Also binomial trees!

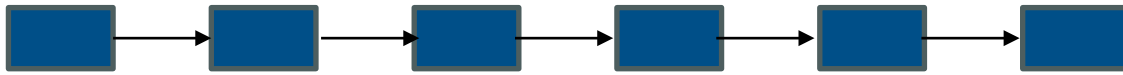
Binary tree:



Also binary trees!

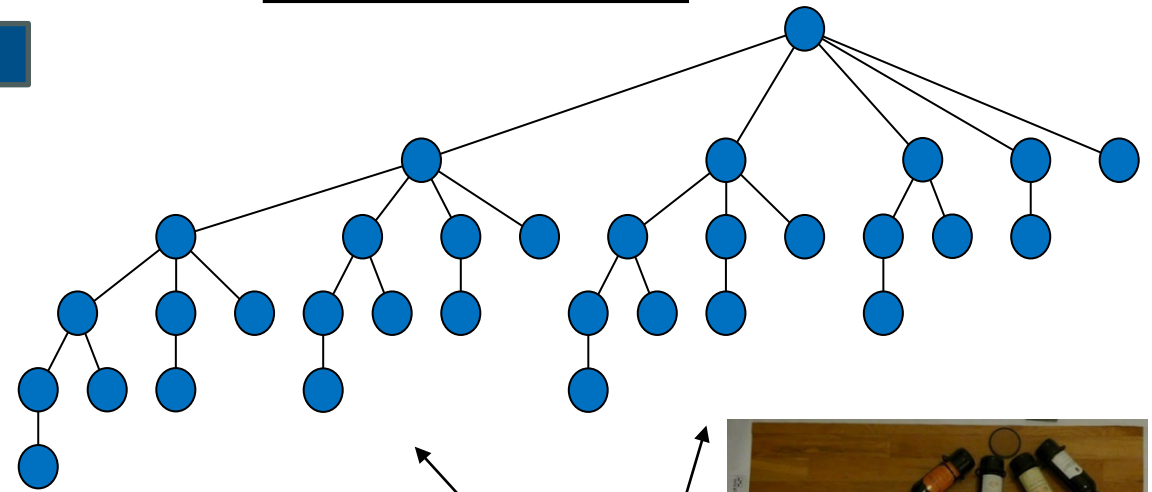
Recursive Structure in Common Data Structures

Linked list:



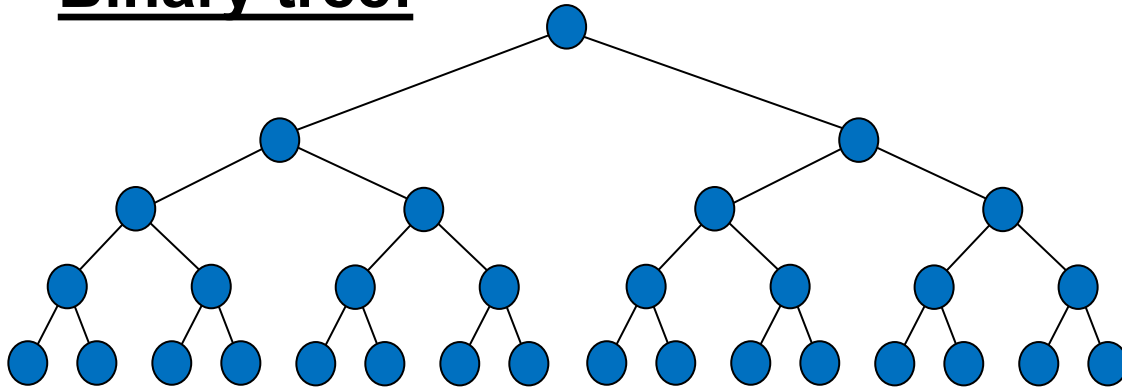
Also a linked list!

Binomial tree:



Also binomial t

Binary tree:

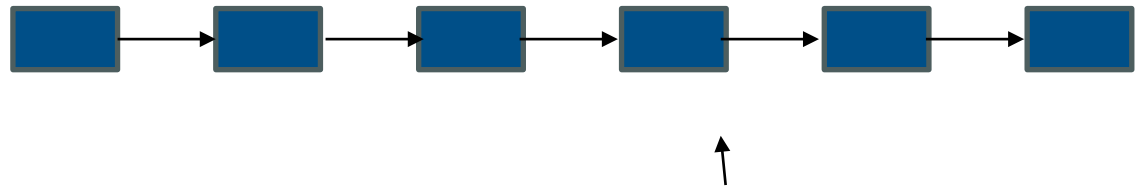


Also binary trees!



Today's Goal

- Practice thinking and coding recursively.
- No loops allowed!
- For simplicity, we'll work with linked lists
- Main Tasks:
 - Reverse a linked list
 - Sort a linked list
(insertion sort, merge sort)



Also a linked list!